DIGITAL DEVICE AND SCREEN USE POLICY

SCHOOLS BEYOND SCREENS PORTLAND DRAFT

I. PURPOSE

This Policy establishes rules for the evaluation, deployment, and use of digital technologies and screen-based devices within Portland Public Schools. It supports PPS's Graduate Portrait and Portland Public Schools' mission to provide an equitable, high-quality education by safeguarding students' physical, social-emotional, and cognitive development, and by ensuring that adopted technologies enhance, rather than diminish learning outcomes and instructional time.

Through clear, consistent, age-appropriate expectations, this Policy reflects a shared responsibility among schools, families, and students to promote academic focus, critical thinking, and healthy, lifelong learning habits, preparing students to be responsible digital citizens throughout their school years and beyond.

II. DEFINITIONS

A. **Personal data**: Any information that identifies or could reasonably identify a student. This includes the categories listed in Section IV.L and data generated through a student's use of a digital tool, such as usage, location, and behavioral data.

B. **Device:** As used in this policy, a device means any PPS-owned, PPS-issued, or PPS-managed laptop, desktop computer, tablet, mobile phone, wearable device, virtual or augmented reality equipment, or other internet-connected hardware used to access PPS systems or instructional content.

C. **Digital tool:** Any software, application, website, online platform, browser extension, or online service accessed on a digital device, including learning management systems and assessment platforms.

D. **Educational Technology:** Educational Technology means software, digital applications, online services, websites, platforms, and other digital tools used for instructional, assessment, accessibility, safety, communication, or administrative purposes.

E. **Technology Education" or "TechEd:** Instruction in which the technology itself is the learning objective, including computer literacy, keyboarding, research skills, and computer science.

F. **Approved Educational Technology:** Approved Educational Technology means Educational Technology that PPS has reviewed and authorized under its educational technology approval process.

G. **PPS Digital Toolkit** means the District's published list of approved digital tools, including

the approved grade levels and uses for each tool and any features the District has disabled.

H. **Core Digital Curriculum Product:** A District-adopted or District-licensed instructional program that students use on a device for instruction, practice, or assessment as part of a structured curriculum, such as i-Ready.

I. **Screen Time:** Screen Time refers to the amount of time a student is expected to view or interact with device displays, including structured educational technology used for instruction and unstructured or non-instructional media. Screen Time does not include use of assistive technology required to provide a student with access to instruction or PPS services.

J. **Independent Evidence**: means at least one study that:

1. Was conducted or validated by a party with no financial interest in the product
2. Meets at least Tier 3 ("promising") of the ESSA evidence standards
3. Measures retention or application of the targeted skill outside the tool, ideally at least one week after use
4. Included students comparable in grade level and learning needs to those who will use the tool

K. **Generative artificial intelligence" or "generative AI**: Software that produces text, images, audio, video, or code in response to user prompts. This includes large language model (LLM) chatbots and generative AI features embedded within other digital tools.

III. STANDARDS FOR SCREEN USE IN INSTRUCTION

A. **Proven Benefit Standard**. Digital tools will be used when they offer a clear, evidence-based advantage over non-digital methods in meeting curricular objectives.

B. **Multi-Sensory Learning Priority.** Screens will be used only for specific, approved purposes and will not replace hands-on, experiential learning.

C. **Paper-Based Materials.** Paper-based materials will be the primary medium for instruction and assignments in reading, writing, and mathematics. Students will complete written drafts and revisions by hand, particularly in the early grades. As students advance and demonstrate mastery of these foundational skills, digital tools may be introduced gradually to supplement, rather than replace, paper-based learning.

IV. GENERAL RULES AND RESTRICTIONS

The following rules will apply to all digital device and screen use, except as dictated by Individualized education plans (IEPs), 504 plans, or Personalized education plans (PEPs):

A. **Centralized Device Use for K-8**. Devices will be used to support specific in-class curriculum and learning activities and will not serve as the primary instructional medium, unless the student is participating in an online school or class approved or delivered by PPS. PPS will

not operate a standard one-to-one take-home Device program for students in Pre-K through Grade 8.

B. **K-8 Screen-Free Periods**. Recess, lunch, and passing periods will be screen- and device-free for grades K-8 by default.

C. **Screen-Free Lunch for Grade 9-12**. The use of computers during high school lunch periods will be restricted to specific classrooms or library areas specifically designated as study halls.

D. **Instructional Flexibility.** PPS recognizes that some courses and learning experiences may require greater use of technology to achieve their instructional objectives. Screen time guidance should be applied with consideration for the unique requirements of courses such as computer science, graphic design, digital media arts, yearbook, engineering, career technical education pathways, film studies, and other technology-intensive programs. In these courses and programs, technology use may exceed general screen time recommendations when it is directly connected to curriculum, student creation, design, programming, production, research, or other active learning experiences. Such use should remain purposeful, instructionally aligned, and consistent with the goals of this policy.

E. **Offline Homework**. Homework assignments will be offered in a paper format whenever possible. Internet connectivity will not be required for the completion of homework assignments. This does not prohibit the use of a learning management system in grades 6-12.

F. **Use only PPS approved digital tools and apps.** PPS-approved digital tools/apps will be vetted as detailed in this policy and approved to ensure they are safe, effective, and legal.. When students are using devices, all teachers, including substitutes, will utilize PPS-approved monitoring tools (ie Securly, etc.) to monitor student screen use for appropriateness.

Staff may not require or direct students to create accounts, disclose personal information, upload student work, or use an educational technology service unless the service has been approved through the PPS educational technology review process. Staff may not accept click-though terms on behalf of PPS or use free applications, browser extensions, pilot programs, or artificial intelligence tools unless authorized under that process.

G. **Prohibition on Advertisement and Sales.** No advertisements will appear on any computer device or projected screen at school. Any device used at school, including those used by teachers or administrators, must be installed with premium ad blockers. Furthermore, students and families will not be required to use any app or website that pushes “paid upgrades,” “premium services,” “in-app purchases,” or similar features.[1]

H. **Educational Use of Video, Visual Media, and Other Content.** PPS digital devices will

[1] American Psychological Association. (2026). Children’s and adolescents’ learning with educational technology.

only be used for curriculum-aligned educational purposes that promote active student engagement. This applies in all instructional settings, including specials such as music, art, physical education, and library. Video and device use should not be used as a substitute for teacher-led instruction, classroom engagement, or active learning experiences, and should be followed by opportunities for discussion, reflection, application, or other forms of student interaction. Instructional video content should be presented by the teacher on a shared display for whole-class viewing rather than viewed on individual student devices whenever possible. Non-educational use including passive consumption for entertainment, gaming, or video streaming, will be prohibited and blocked without administrator approval.[2] Background video or visual media not aligned to active instruction should not be used. When not in active use, devices and projection screens should be off and away. Exceptions for specific disability related needs as outlined in an IEP or 504 plan are allowed.

I. Gamified Learning Applications. Game mechanics can shift students' attention from understanding content to earning rewards and reduce their interest in learning once rewards are removed.

1. The following features will be disabled in any approved digital tool or app, and tools that cannot disable them will not be approved:
    a. Chance-based or unpredictable rewards, such as spins, mystery boxes, or random prizes
    b. Non-instructional games, videos, or play time as a reward for academic work
    c. Streaks or other features that pressure students to return or penalize missed sessions
    d. Public leaderboards or student rankings
    e. Notifications drawing students back to the platform outside assigned use.

2. This provision does not apply to non-digital classroom games or displays showing which skills a student has mastered.

J. **Prohibition on Screen-Time as Reward**. Individual digital device use or screen time will not be used as a reward, incentive, or behavioral reinforcement for students.[3]

K. **Data Collection**. Students' personal data (including, but not limited to, health records, grades, behavior, test scores, immigration status, birth location, household income, and SSNs) will not be harvested, packaged, or sold by apps or learning management systems.[4] Any apps accessible to students must publish their complete terms of service and privacy policies.

L. **Platform and Content Restrictions.**

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[2] Wall Street Journal, Screens Have Taken Over Classrooms. Even Students Have Had Enough. Educators question whether the rapid shift toward more technology has benefited learning; New York Times, How Much Screen Time Is Your Child Getting at School? We Asked 350 Teachers.
[3] Deci, E. L., Koestner, R., & Ryan, R. M. (1999). A meta analytic review of experiments examining the effects of extrinsic rewards on intrinsic motivation. Psychological Bulletin, 125(6), 627–668.
[4] NBC News, Google's work in schools aims to create a 'pipeline of future users'

1. **Content Filtering.** Students should be able to use District technology safely and stay focused on learning. The District will use two tiers of content filtering on District student devices and accounts.
    a. **Global Filtering:** The District will filter all District student devices and accounts, on and off campus, consistent with Board Policy 8.60.040-P and the Children's Internet Protection Act, including the restrictions in Section IV.L.2.
    b. **Classroom Allow Lists:** For each Core Digital Curriculum product, the District will provide a Classroom Allow List that limits student access to that product and the sites it needs to work.
    c. **Educator Use:** When students use a Core Digital Curriculum product in class, educators shall apply the District-provided Classroom Allow List for that product. Classroom Allow Lists do not apply to research, creation, or other activities outside a Core Digital Curriculum product. Global Filtering stays in effect at all times.
    d. **Individual Access:** Classroom Allow Lists shall not block assistive technology, translation tools, or other resources required by a student's IEP, 504 plan, or language access needs.
    e. **Implementation:** The annual report, as specified elsewhere in this policy, shall list each Core Digital Curriculum product, whether it has a Classroom Allow List, and, if not, why.

2. **Administrative Directive | Implements Content Filtering**
    a. **Purpose**
    This Administrative Directive implements Section IV.L.1 of this Policy. Classroom Allow Lists keep students inside the curriculum product they are using during class. They are built once per product and run on the District's existing classroom management tool, currently Securly Classroom, so no new software purchase is required.
    b. **Developing Classroom Allow Lists**
        i. The Office of Technology and Information Services (OTIS), working with the Office of Teaching and Learning, shall keep a list of Core Digital Curriculum products. It shall publish a Classroom Allow List for each product to all educators as a shared, District-approved collection.
        ii. Timelines: Classroom Allow Lists for Core Digital Curriculum in use when this directive is adopted shall be available by [the start of the 2027–28 school year]. For products adopted later, the list shall be available before classroom use begins.
        iii. Exceptions: If OTIS determines that a product cannot work under a Classroom Allow List, OTIS shall record the reason. The product will be reported as an exception in the annual report to the Board.
    c. **Procurement and Renewal**
        i. When the District adopts, purchases, or renews Core Digital Curriculum, it shall confirm that the product can work under a Classroom Allow List.

ii. Contracts and renewals should require the vendor to provide a current list of required domains and to notify the District when that list changes.

d. **Educator Use**
   i. When students use a Core Digital Curriculum product in class, educators shall start a classroom management session and apply that product's Classroom Allow List.
   ii. If the product doesn't work while the Classroom Allow List is applied, the educator may remove it for the rest of the session and report the problem to the OTIS Help Desk. OTIS shall update the list.
   iii. Classroom Allow Lists are not meant for open-ended research, creation, or exploratory learning. For those activities, Global Filtering applies, and educators use professional judgment to keep students on task and supervise device use under Section IV.F.

e. **Individual Access**
   i. OTIS shall set assistive technology and translation tools to remain available whenever a Classroom Allow List is applied. A student's IEP or 504 team may request that additional resources be added.

f. **Training**
   i. Educators who use Core Digital Curriculum shall be trained to apply Classroom Allow Lists. This training should be part of existing training on the product or on the classroom management tool, supported by a one-page quick-reference guide.

3. **Student Blocked Access**. PPS will block access to student-led use of YouTube, social media, and streaming platforms, AI/LLM chatbot platforms (ie ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, etc.), along with non-approved gaming platforms.[5] Exceptions may only be permitted for educator-directed instructional use when a platform directly supports curriculum-aligned learning objectives.

M. **Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Large Language Models (LLMs).** Access to generative AI is prohibited on student-facing, PPS-issued devices until the PPS Board/District adopts an AI policy and research-backed AI literacy curriculum is implemented district wide.[6]

V. TIME LIMITATIONS ON DEVICE USE

A. **Maximum Limits for Screen Use for K-12 (excluding TechEd)**. Total in-class screen time will not exceed the following and can be balanced over the course of a unit of

[5] The Conversation, The 'one chatbot per child' model for AI in classrooms conflicts with what research shows: Learning is a social process; Ben Williamson et al., National Education Policy Center, Time for a Pause: Without Effective Public Oversight, AI in Schools Will Do More Harm Than Good.

[6] 3 reasons why 'going slow to go fast' is the right approach for AI in schools (Brookings Institute, Sept 2026); NPR, The risks of AI in schools outweigh the benefits, report says.

instruction to allow for flexibility:

Grade	Weekly Limit	Flexibility	In Practice (Ad. Dir.)
P	0 minutes	No routine use	No routine use
K–2	0 minutes	No routine use. Up to 90 minutes of screen-based practice before each mandated assessment	No routine use outside mandated assessments
3	100 minutes	Minutes may be averaged over a unit	20 minutes per day
4-5	150 minutes	Minutes may be averaged over a unit	30 minutes per day
6–8	300 minutes	Minutes may be averaged over a unit	45 minutes per subject/week
9–12	480 minutes	Minutes may be averaged over a unit	60 minutes per subject/week

These limits apply to students' use of individual devices. They do not apply to static projected materials (e.g., a document or slideshow displayed for common reference) or to brief, teacher-led video shown to the whole class in support of a lesson. Extended video viewing should be infrequent. In grades K–2, teacher-led video should be limited to occasional short clips that serve a clear instructional purpose.

B. **Exceptions:** Exceptions to the time limitations set forth in this Section may be granted under the following circumstances:

1. IEPs, 504 plans, or PEPs*
2. Emergency situations requiring immediate communication or safety measures
3. Temporary, unexpected teacher substitutions where prepared lesson plans necessitate screen-based instruction
4. Special assemblies featuring guest speakers or presentations that require audiovisual components
5. Other special circumstances approved in advance by the principal.

*Online curriculum should not be used for specialized designed instruction (SDI) or modified curriculum unless there is a specific IEP goal that is being addressed.

VI. PROHIBITION OF ONE-TO-ONE DEVICES

A. **Prohibition on One-to-One Devices.** PPS will not issue individual devices to K-8 students. All student access to digital devices will be limited to shared devices in dedicated computer labs or supervised computer carts as set forth in Section IV of this Policy.

B. **Exceptions.** Students may take PPS devices home to address an identified instructional, accessibility, equity, or academic-support need, as approved by the principal or designee, or as required by an individualized education program ("IEP"), Section 504 plan, or applicable law. PPS will provide the student's parent or guardian with notice of the take-home arrangement and obtain an acknowledgment of applicable device-use requirements. Failure to return an acknowledgment will not prevent PPS from providing a device when the device is required to provide the student with equal access, appropriate services, or legally required accommodations.

VII. Digital Literacy

PPS will integrate developmentally appropriate Digital Literacy instruction into the core curriculum for grades K–12.

A. Digital Literacy instruction will focus on:

1. Evaluating source credibility and detecting misinformation;
2. Understanding data privacy and the Responsible Use Policy;
3. The environmental and social impacts of digital technologies;
4. Safe and respectful use of digital tools;
5. Skills to critically evaluate digital content;
6. Developing critical thinking, creativity, communication, collaboration, empathy, judgment, and independent problem-solving skills in a rapidly evolving technological world; and
7. Maintaining healthy technology habits, including attention management, period breaks, ergonomics, and awareness of persuasive or engagement-focused design.

VIII. Parent and Guardian Rights

A. **Transparency.** PPS shall maintain a public, online, current listing of all digital tools approved for student use and relevant information about each, updated within 30 days of any addition or change and sent annually to parents and guardians[7].

Administrative Directive | For each tool, the listing shall include:

1. Whether it incorporates generative AI

[7] ACLU, Digital Dystopia: The Danger in Buying What the EdTech Surveillance Industry is Selling.; UNESCO. (2023). Global education monitoring report 2023: Technology in education: A tool on whose terms?

2. Features PPS has disabled
3. How it was vetted against district standards
4. A plain-language summary of what student data it collects, how that data is used and stored, and who it is shared with
5. A link to the full privacy policy

B. **Access.** Parents and guardians will have access to information specific to their child, including the apps, programs, and services their child's class/school uses and their child's estimated or actual weekly device time, with the method used to calculate that time.

C. **Parental Consent.** PPS will obtain annual consent from a parent or guardian before a student under the age of 18 may use:

1. Any Google Workspace for Education Additional Service, or any third-party service for which consent is required by law or by the vendor's terms.
2. Any tool or feature that uses generative AI to process student input or work, whether or not the vendor classifies it as a core service.
3. Consent will be requested separately for each service, not bundled into a single blanket form.
4. Students without consent for a service shall receive an equivalent alternative and will not be penalized.

IX. DIGITAL TOOL VETTING AND APPROVAL PROCESS

A. Rubric and Vetting. PPS, in collaboration with the Technology Advisory Committee, will review and update the PPS Digital Technology and App Approval Process with a formal, transparent rubric and vetting process to evaluate ed tech and digital tools. The rubric will consider targeted learning objectives, independent evidence*, cognitive processes, student data privacy and safety, attention-capturing design and game mechanics, and time bound requirements.

New student-facing digital products should only be adopted when there are proven benefits over analog alternatives. A process for teachers and staff to request approval for a new tool or app should also be in place.[8]

*Independent evidence as defined above.

X. TECHNOLOGY AUDIT PROCESS

A. **Regular Technology Audit**. The Office of Internal Performance auditor will conduct annual audits of all digital tools and technologies currently in use across all grade levels and programs. The Technology Advisory Committee (discussed below) will review audit findings and make recommendations.

[8]American Psychological Association. (2026). Children's and adolescents' learning with educational technology.

These audits will evaluate:

1. Continued compliance with approval criteria
2. Actual learning outcomes achieved
3. Any reported adverse effects on student privacy, learning, physical and mental health
4. Budget impacts

C. **Removal of Tools**. Any digital tool found to not meet approval criteria will be removed from use within ninety 90 days of such determination.

XI. FACULTY AND STAFF SUPPORT

A. Ongoing Professional Support. PPS will provide educators and staff with ongoing training, guidance, and resources to implement this policy, including:

1. **Instructional practice:** effective, curriculum-aligned use of digital tools, and high-quality non-digital alternatives.
2. **Platform and tool training:** hands-on training on each approved platform and app before staff are expected to use it with students, including privacy and data settings, how to disable restricted features, and how to confirm parental consent status where it is required.
3. **Consistent, equitable enforcement:** clear districtwide standards and procedures so that the same behavior results in the same response for every student, with an emphasis on non-exclusionary responses rather than confiscation or discipline.
4. **Digital literacy instruction:** strategies for teaching students to regulate their own technology use, evaluate information, and protect their privacy.
5. **Policy procedures:** using the allow list request process, and meeting accommodation obligations for assistive technology and students with IEPs or 504 plans.

XII. STAKEHOLDER COLLABORATION AND OVERSIGHT

A. **Technology Advisory Committee.** PPS will maintain a Technology Advisory Committee that ideally includes technology personnel, educators, administrators, psychologists, students, and parents to review how technology is implemented throughout the district.

B. **Committee Responsibilities.** The Technology Advisory Committee will:

1. Work with PPS to develop a digital tool rubric
2. Work with PPS to write administrative directive related to this policy
3. Review and recommend updates to this Policy annually
4. Evaluating impacts of digital tools and platforms on the learning and well-being of students
5. Evaluate proposed new technologies prior to adoption
6. Monitor research and developments in educational technology and child health
7. Collect information from parents, faculty, and staff regarding technology use
8. Evaluate outcomes of digital literacy curriculum and recommend changes as needed

9. Report findings and recommendations to the school board as a component in the District Annual Report.

XIII. MONITORING, ACCOUNTABILITY, AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

A. **Policy Review.** The Technology Advisory Committee will review this Policy annually and make suggestions to the board to update as necessary based on current research, stakeholder feedback, and operational experience. The policy will be updated as needed to reflect new research, implementation feedback, equity analyses, and emerging tools and information. The first annual review will include feedback from students, educators, administrators, staff, parents, and families regarding policy implementation and data on screen time usage.

B. **District Annual Report to the Board**
The District will provide an annual report to the Board, presented no later than May detailing the implementation of this Policy. The report will include, at minimum:

1. **Screen Time Data.** A summary of average student screen time across the District, compared against the goals and benchmarks established under this Policy.
2. **Digital Tools and Platforms in Use.** A current inventory of approved applications, digital tools, and commonly used websites utilized for instructional purposes and associated costs. Data on learning outcomes for each tool should be presented as well.
3. **Digital and AI Literacy Curriculum.** An update on the implementation and status of digital and artificial intelligence literacy curricula, including progress made, instructional outcomes, and consistency of implementation across schools.
4. **Data Privacy Incidents.** A summary of any student data privacy issues or incidents that arose during the school year, including the nature of each issue and the steps taken to address or mitigate it.
5. **Monitoring and Filtering Systems.** An update on the effectiveness of device monitoring and content-filtering systems, including efforts to ensure device use remains educational, minimizes access to distracting or non-instructional content, and maintains a safe digital environment for students. Include filtering mishaps and mitigation strategies.
6. **Emerging Research.** A summary of relevant, current research on educational technology, screen use, and child development, and how such research may inform future updates to this Policy.
7. **Disaggregation of Data.** Wherever possible, data provided under this section will be disaggregated by classroom, grade band, individual school, and historically underserved student groups, to allow the Board to identify disparities in implementation, access, or outcomes.
8. **Technology Advisory Committee Findings and Recommendations.**

Note:

For further reading and supporting materials, please visit our recommended reading list here: https://schoolsbeyondscreens.com/c/portland/learn-more

APPENDIX A: GUIDING PRINCIPLES

These guiding principles were conceived with the whole child in mind, centering around the question of what is truly best for all children's learning and development.

A. **Research-backed Pedagogy**. Neuroscientific research shows that effective learning requires sustained focus, deliberate effort, and emotional, and relational connection.[9] Students require a balance of direct instruction, social interaction and collaboration, physical activity, and hands-on learning. Technology use should not replace these essential experiences. Reading comprehension is often lower when on a screen rather than paper.[10] Multitasking and gamification can diminish learning.[11] Whenever possible, independent research should be used to evaluate the efficacy of digital tools.

B. **Teacher-led Instruction First:** Learning is the most effective when directed and guided by skilled educators and meaningful human interaction.[12] Technology should support and enhance teacher-led instruction, not replace the essential role of educators in fostering engagement, relationships, and learning.

C. **Adaptability**. Cognitive skills and habits of mind enable students to adapt to evolving circumstances and future technological trends. Teaching students to think deeply enables them to use any tool; teaching students to use a specific tool limits them to that tool.

D. **Real-life and Multi-sensory Practices**. Analog learning methods–including whole book reading and handwriting as well as paper based math and use of manipulatives–reliably produce stronger comprehension and retention than digital methods.[13]

E. **Student Health and Well-Being**. Excessive device use has been shown to be correlated with poor attention, distraction, anxiety, depression, myopia, and sleep disruption among children and adolescents.[14] Students deserve learning environments that minimize distractions and maximize

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[9] Written Testimony of Dr. Jenny Radesky and Written Testimony of Dr. Jean Twenge, Hearing before the U.S. Senate Committee on Commerce, Science, and Transportation (Jan. 15, 2026).

[10] American Psychological Association. (2026). Children's and adolescents' learning with educational technology; Tiffany Munzer, et al., Digital Ecosystems, Children, and Adolescents: Policy Statement. Pediatrics February 2026; 157 (2): e2025075320. 10.1542/peds.2025-075320

[11] Michael D. Hanus, Jesse Fox, Assessing the effects of gamification in the classroom: A longitudinal study on intrinsic motivation, social comparison, satisfaction, effort, and academic performance, Computers & Education, Volume 80, 2015, Pages 152-161, ISSN 0360-1315, https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compedu.2014.08.019.

[12] Written Testimony of Dr. Jared Cooney Horvath, Hearing before the U.S. Senate Committee on Commerce, Science, and Transportation (Jan. 15, 2026).

[13] Dr. Jared Cooney Horvath, *The Digital Delusion*; New York Times, Kids Rarely Read Whole Books Anymore, Even in English Class.

[14] Meri, R., Hutton, J., Farah, R., DiFrancesco, M., Gozman, L., & Horowitz-Kraus, T. (2023). Higher access to screens is related to decreased functional connectivity between neural networks associated with basic attention skills and cognitive

engagement. Portland Public Schools devices and systems should prioritize curriculum-aligned educational resources and prohibit access to content that does not directly support learning.

F. **Equity and Inclusion**. Excessive reliance on edtech can reinforce inequity and widen the achievement gap. The new "digital divide" will be defined by access (or lack thereof) to high quality, screen-free instruction.[15] However, students will need to have access to meaningful opportunities to engage with technology, including for tech education, assessments, differentiated learning, instructional accommodations, and accessibility supports while ensuring that no group of students experiences disproportionate exposure to passive or excessive screen time. Use of devices for students with diverse needs, including but not limited to students with disabilities and English Learners, gifted learners, and students requiring specialized instructional support, will be protected.

G: **Set educators up for success.** Educators need robust support, including time for professional development around research-backed analog instruction and differentiation methods, use of technology-based curriculum with intention and confidence to support student learning, and teaching digital literacy effectively.[16]

H. **Technology Education vs. Technology-Delivered Education**. Technology Education ("**TechEd**") is distinct from Education Technology ("**EdTech**"). TechEd refers to a curriculum of computer literacy and may include, among other things, typing and research instruction. EdTech refers to digital tools, software, platforms, and devices used to deliver core subject content.

I. **Transparency.** Educators need clear guidelines on acceptable digital platforms, devices, and screen use. Families need clear communication at the start of each school year about what to expect regarding screen time, educational app and tool use, and the data privacy policies governing these tools.[17]

J. **Data privacy.** Some data can help show when and why a learner is struggling, but the same information can be used for marketing, product development, or other purposes that do not directly benefit the learner. Policies should protect learners, only allowing vetted products and tools with compliant data collection and privacy policies.[18]

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control in children. Child Neuropsychology, *29*(4), 666-685; Ha A, Lee YJ, Lee M, Shim SR, Kim YK. Digital Screen Time and Myopia: A Systematic Review and Dose-Response Meta-Analysis. JAMA Netw Open. 2025;8(2):e2460026; Tiffany Munzer, et al., Digital Ecosystems, Children, and Adolescents: Policy Statement. Pediatrics February 2026, 157 (2): e2025075320. 10.1542/peds.2025-075320.

[15] The Atlantic, The Best Parenting Hack Is Being Rich (Aug. 2026); UNESCO. (2023). Global education monitoring report 2023: Technology in education: A tool on whose terms?; Faith Bonniger et al., National Education Policy Center, Fit for Purpose? How Today's Commercial Digital Platforms Subvert Key Goals of Public Education.

[16] American Psychological Association. (2026). Children's and adolescents' learning with educational technology.

[17] UNICEF, Child Protection in Digital Education

[18] The Markup, This Private Equity Firm Is Amassing Companies That Collect Data on America's Children: Vista Equity Partners has been buying up software used in schools.; NBC News, Google's work in schools aims to create a 'pipeline of future users,' internal documents say.